

University Work At Computer Bureau

Computer work for the University of Canterbury and Lincoln College is being done by the Computer Bureau, Ltd., set up last year by 10 South Island companies at the prompting of two firms of accountants.

As the university's computer at Ilam is working to capacity, the bureau has undertaken computer work for the accountancy department on farm management accounting, and is producing a monthly cash flow comparison between actual and projected farm operations.

Lincoln College has been getting weekly and fortnightly computer data on a Northland farm potential survey which has been made by college staff at Whangarei.

Another Lincoln computer project, using matrix algebra, is an inter-industry economic survey, covering all aspects of New Zealand's development with projections up to 10 years ahead.

The bureau has a staff of 25, including 12 programmers, 10 punch-card operators and three computer operators. One of its biggest jobs for commerce and industry is to process more than 70,000 policies held with the S.I.M.U.

The records are being maintained in a form which could lead to an entirely new method of assessing premiums.

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